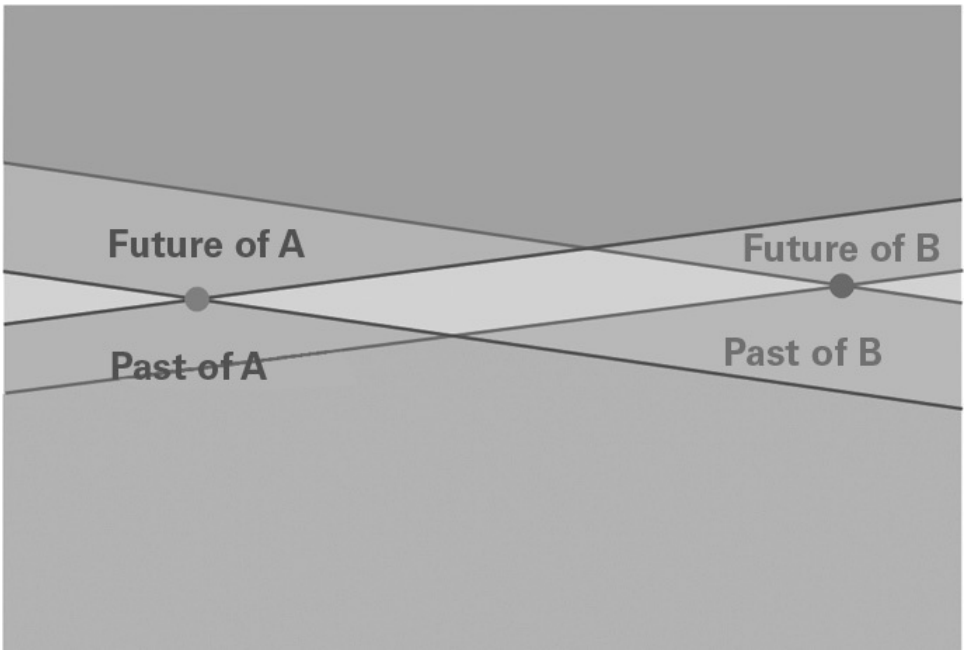
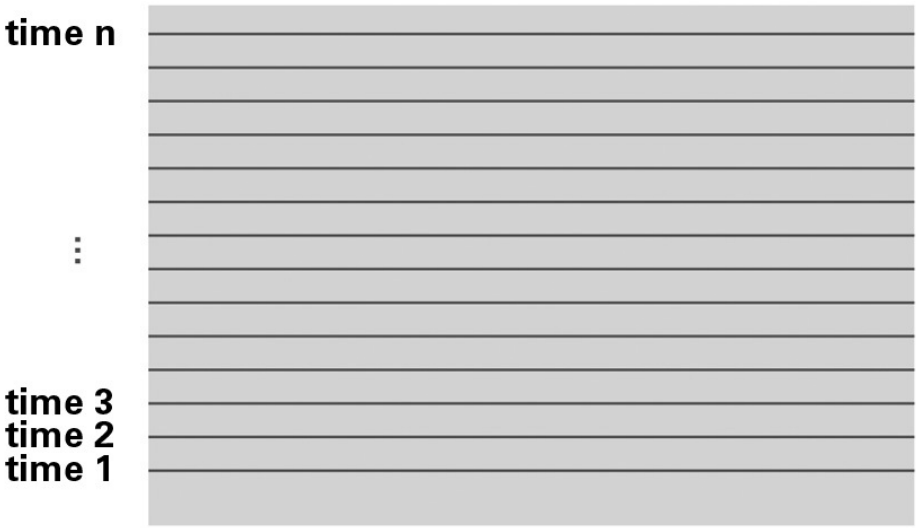


The reason for this is that, at the scale to which we are accustomed, the expanded present separating our past from our future is extremely brief (a matter of nanoseconds) and almost imperceptible, as a result of which it is "squashed" into a thin horizontal band we usually call "the present," without any qualification.

In short, a common present does not exist: the temporal structure of spacetime is not a stratification of times such as this:



It is, rather, a structure made up entirely of light cones: